

Cacao Tea

The \$500K China Market Opportunity

Blue Ocean · TCM Bridge · 4 Target Segments

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Executive Summary

" 中国可卡的饮料还没有人做 " — No one makes cacao drinks in China

Market: Health tea = ¥642.7B (\$89B), 25.3% growth. Cacao drinks: \$0 — no domestic competitor

Economics: \$44/kg COGS → \$50 retail box (40g). Min viable: 249/mo. Target: 10,000/yr @ 56% margin

Impact: \$5/box → 1 tree → 4 tons CO₂. 10,000 trees/yr at target

Supply: La Dio Sitio, 4 ha, Pará — capacity = exactly our target

4 Segments: Single career women (×2) · Married couples 10yr+ · Gen Z gift-givers



Brand
Price
China?

Dedicated
Chocolate
(HK)

Raycas
Dana

Market White Space

only HK/OVS brands — zero on Taobao/Tmall/JD

Key Finding

We're the first domestic producer with TCM positioning, local flavors (Chaoshan chen pi, Sichuan pepper), and a regenerative farm story.

Product
Epicatechin
Price
Shell
tea
(40g box)
Concentration

The Active Ingredient: Epicatechin (表儿茶素)

CSF — 30 days, 2x circulating stem cells (JACC 2010)

Same NO pathway as Viagra & statins

Epicatechin upregulates NO → bone marrow releases stem cells to repair blood vessels

Harvard researcher Eric Ding: "Viagra improves flow — same as cocoa"

Theobromine (1.5-3%) = sustained vasodilation without caffeine jitters

Dual product: shell tea (mass) + epicatechin concentrate (premium supplement)



The TCM Bridge — Cacao Meets Chinese Medicine

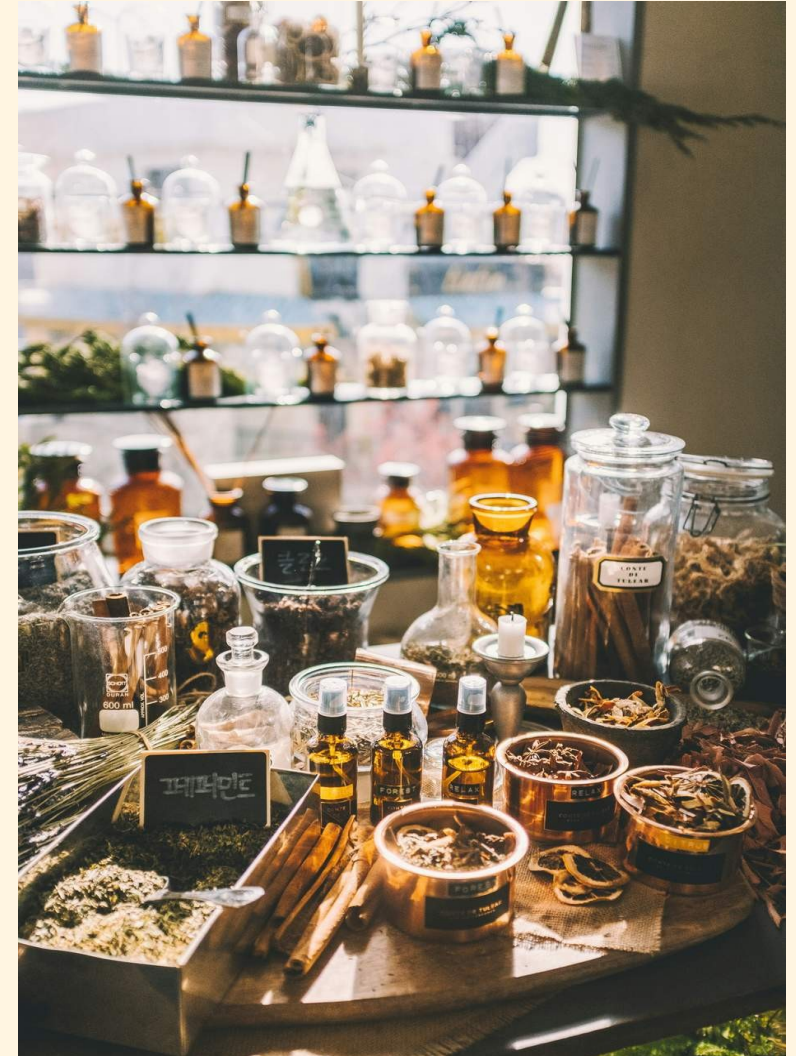
We create the TCM-cacao category from scratch

TCM Properties: 性温 (Warming), 味苦 (Bitter), 归心 / 肝 / 肾 (Heart/Liver/Kidney)

Actions: Tonifies Heart, warms Kidney Yang, moves Blood, calms Shen

4 Blends: 养心安神 · 温中健脾 · 疏肝解郁 · 温肾壮阳

Each can (4g) = cacao shell base + TCM herbs for functional effect



Segment A: Single Career Women — "Connect to Your Divine Feminine"

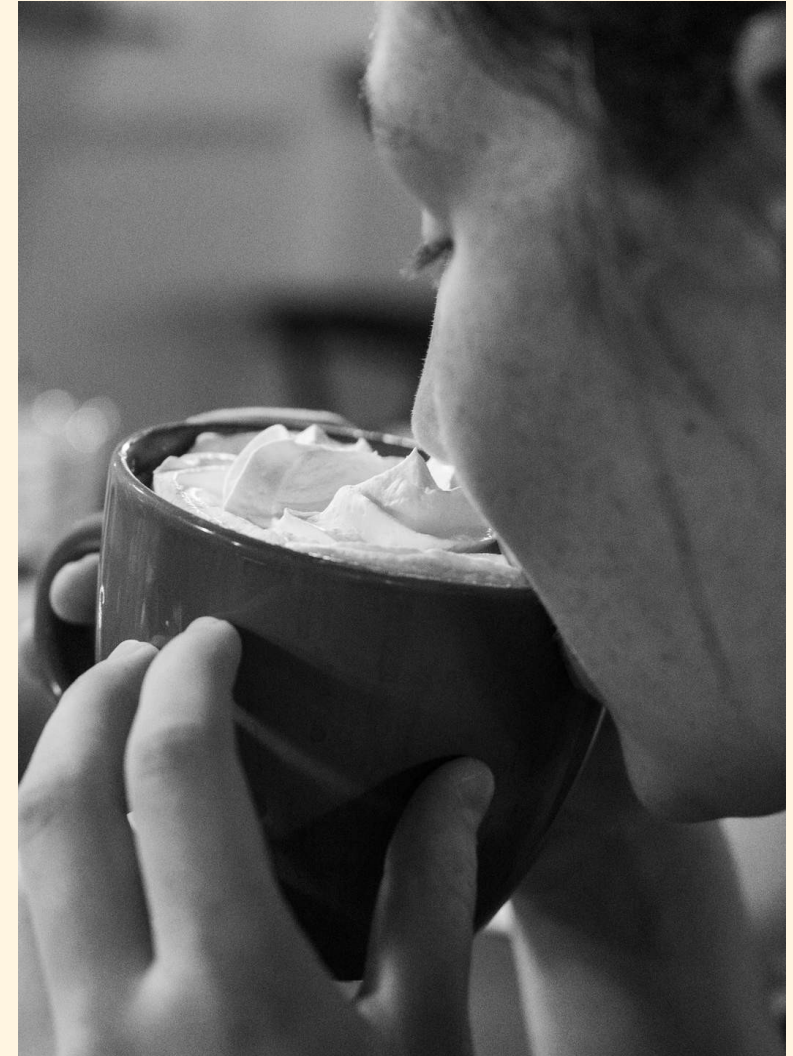
28-40 urban, ¥200K-500K/yr — self-care first

Psychographic: High stress, emotional loneliness, "leftover women" pressure, wellness daily (¥5K+ /mo)

Hero: Heart-Nourishing blend (养心安神)

Tagline: " 你值得被温暖 " — You deserve to be warmed. Connect to your divine feminine.

Why cacao wins: TCM herbs are bitter/slow — cacao gives immediate mood lift via serotonin + anandamide



Segment B: Single Career Women — "Radiant & Divine Feminine"

Same demo, different need: outer glow, desirability, confidence

Psychographic: Beauty-from-within — \$3.2B market, 6.2% CAGR

Science: 12-week clinical — 47.5% improved hydration, collagen, wrinkle reduction

UCSF: 2x stem cells = skin regeneration from within

Hero: Liver-Soothing (疏肝解郁) or Pure Shell. Tagline:
" 每天一杯可可茶，喝出光彩 "

Why cacao beats 燕窝 (bird's nest): bird's nest \$2K-5K/kg, slow —
cacao is \$44/kg, immediate



Segment C: Married Couples >10 Yrs — "Yesterday We Were Young"

35-55, conjugal fatigue, desire to rekindle

Psychographic: 老夫老妻 mentality, kidney deficiency, low libido. Both tired from work + kids.

Hero: Couple's Box — 2×10 cans: Heart-Nourishing + Kidney-Warming (温肾壮阳)

Tagline: " 昨天的我们，青春正好 " — Yesterday we were young, vibrant, alive

The NO pathway = same vascular mechanism as Viagra (Harvard/JACC)

Montezuma drank cacao before visiting his wives — 3,000-year tradition

Why cacao beats 鹿茸 (deer antler): deer antler \$1K-10K/kg, cooking needed, controversial, animal-derived

Cacao: \$44/kg, just add water, works immediately, plant-based, romantic, sustainable

Segment D: Gen Z Gift-Giving — "A Gift of Peace of Mind"

Men 20-28 buying for girlfriends — ¥80K-200K/yr

Psychographic: 41% of wellness spend from under-35s. Gift = status signaling + thoughtfulness.

Hero: Gift Edition (送礼版) — 10-can 小罐茶 box, premium packaging

Tagline: " 她更想要的，是一份安心 " — What she really wants is peace of mind

Why cacao beats skincare: skincare = generic. Cacao = Amazon + TCM + carbon-negative = unique story

Channels: Xiaohongshu unboxing, Douyin gift guides, Dr. Ye's endorsement



Cacao vs. Luxury TCM Ingredients			
The only ingredient that tastes good, works immediately, and costs \$44/kg			
Ingredient	Price/kg	Mechanism	Experience
冬虫夏草 (Cordyceps)	\$20K - 60K	ATP, immune	Unpleasant, fungal, needs cooking

Metric		Value
Operating P&L		
\$500K target		
Revenue target		\$500,000 / yr
Boxes		10,000 / yr
		(833 / mo)
Re		\$5

Every Box Plants a Tree

\$5 → 1 cacao tree → 4 tons CO₂



\$5 per box = reforestation fund

**10,000 boxes/yr → \$50K fund →
10,000 trees → 40,000 tons CO₂**

The carbon story is clean, simple, and emotionally compelling

Customers buy cacao tea and literally regrow the Amazon

Next Steps — What We Need Now

Actions to unlock the \$500K target

- 1. TCM Specialist — formulate 4 blends**
- 2. Analysis Lab — nutritional, heavy metals, pesticide for import**
- 3. KOL Recruit — budget allocated (\$24K/yr + \$40K events), talent needed**
- 4. Packaging — Ling to quote (aluminum cans, box, labels)**
- 5. China Import Compliance — legal review**
- 6. Dr. Ye's Douyin side account — weight-loss channel for product launch**